

I. 詞彙：請選出 1 個最合適的答案，每題 2 分，共 12 分

1. In order to stay ahead in the competitive market, the company encourages its employees to push the _____ and come up with creative ideas.
(A) silver (B) whole (C) thought (D) envelope
2. Our effort was made to no _____ as our work faced unexpected challenges.
(A) goal (B) object (C) purpose (D) influence
3. Mary couldn't believe she _____ the scam promising quick riches, realizing later that it was too good to be true.
(A) ended on (B) fell for (C) stuck to (D) took on
4. She pointed to her watch as a _____ that it was getting late and she wanted to leave.
(A) sign (B) surprise (C) mistake (D) choice
5. He usually stays quite _____ in meetings but this time he just lost his head.
(A) safe (B) weak (C) calm (D) proud
6. At first I thought he was a bit shy, but I've come to the conclusion that he's _____ unfriendly!
(A) usually (B) honestly (C) finally (D) simply

II. 綜合測驗：請選出 1 個最合適的答案，每題 2 分，共 24 分

第 7 至 12 題為題組

Bordeaux, in southwest France, is fascinating as a compact and easily navigable city. A weekend visit 7 main sights, but delving into its rich history and cultural offerings is a must. Museums like the Bordeaux Wine and Trade Museum 8 the maritime past 8. Continuing your exploration, stroll through the charming Old Town, 9 beautifully preserved architecture and a vibrant atmosphere await. Bordeaux, a paradise for wine enthusiasts, 10 charms visitors with world-class vineyards in the surrounding countryside—Saint-Émilion and Médoc, both just a leisurely day trip away, beckon for unforgettable experiences. As the sun sets, the city's tempting food 11 comes alive, from fresh seafood to delectable pastries. Bordeaux, blending old-world charm with contemporary allure, 12 you to extend your stay, savoring each moment of an unforgettable French getaway.

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|-------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------|---------------|
| 7. (A) covers | (B) claims | (C) highlights | (D) seeks |
| 8. (A) bring ...to life | | (B) give ... big time | |
| | (C) grow ...on visitors | (D) take ...in the sights | |
| 9. (A) and stop by | (B) as well as | (C) because | (D) where |
| 10. (A) even | (B) further | (C) still | (D) therefore |
| 11. (A) scene | (B) service | (C) shopping | (D) tradition |
| 12. (A) invited | (B) had invited | (C) inviting | (D) invites |

第 13 至 18 題為題組

How can you tell if a person is telling the truth? Scientists at the University of Portsmouth in England believe that they have discovered a way to 13 people in lies.

The study concluded that the human mind has a limited capacity for how much it can think about at one time. Telling the truth doesn't take much mental effort, whereas lying 14. Liars have to invent a story, match it to the facts as they tell it, and remember the details. They also have to control their expressions and watch everyone else to 15 their lie is working.

The scientists from this study say that to spot a lie, investigators just need to increase the cognitive load. One technique is making people 16 their story in reverse. 17 is having them draw a detailed picture of the story they just told. Already loaded down with the effort of lying, a liar's brain won't be able to 18 the extra tasks and the lie will fall apart. If you want to use these lie detection tips, it's important to keep in mind that they don't work for everyone.

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|-------------------|---------------|---------------|------------------|
| 13. (A) treat | (B) catch | (C) position | (D) guide |
| 14. (A) was | (B) is | (C) did | (D) does |
| 15. (A) make sure | (B) think of | (C) follow up | (D) make believe |
| 16. (A) telling | (B) tell | (C) to tell | (D) told |
| 17. (A) Another | (B) The other | (C) Other | (D) One another |
| 18. (A) create | (B) produce | (C) enter | (D) handle |

III. 文意選填：請選出 1 個最合適的答案，每個選項限用一次。每題 2 分，共 16 分
第 19 至 26 題為題組

This January, Japan’s lunar lander completed a successful touchdown on the moon’s surface just after midnight, but a technical 19 related to the craft’s ability to use solar power has made it uncertain whether the 20 will achieve all of its goals. With the landing, Japan becomes just the fifth country to land a craft on the moon, after the U.S., Russia, China and India.

Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) officials said they have good reason to believe that the Smart Lander for Investigating Moon spacecraft made a soft landing and achieved its goal of a high-precision landing, though they said they will need more time to confirm whether the lander achieved the goal of landing within 100 meters of its 21.

“The data are continually being sent to the Earth now after landing, which is 22 that our goal of a soft landing has been achieved,” JAXA President Hiroshi Yamanaka told a news conference at the agency’s campus in Sagamihara, Kanagawa Prefecture.

JAXA officials, however, said that the solar panels on the lander were not generating power and the lander was being 23 by its onboard battery, which would have only lasted for several hours. They added that the lack of electricity from solar panels may limit the duration of the lander’s 24, but said they would do their best to accomplish as much as they can with the power they have. The end of battery power does not mean the end of the mission, the officials stressed.

Officials do not believe the solar panels were 25 during the landing given that the rest of the spacecraft is intact, and noted that as the 26 of the sun changes in the weeks ahead, the panels may start generating electricity.

(A) activities	(B) angle	(C) damaged	(D) evidence
(AB) issue	(AC) mission	(AD) powered	(BC) target site

IV. 閱讀測驗：請選出 1 個最合適的答案，每題 4 分，共 48 分

第 27 至 30 題為題組

The future where robots handle everything for us may be closer than you think. Last week, Stanford released Mobile Aloha, a robot capable of performing various household tasks, from cooking and dishwashing to table wiping. Similarly, Figure, a startup company,

showcased their humanoid robot, Figure One, which has already learned how to brew coffee for you. Their actions may seem simple, but there are some essential aspects to take notice of.

The robots learn to do these tasks on their own without human-programmed instructions. They are equipped with a neural network brain and shown some demonstration data, allowing them to learn autonomously. Once the learning is completed, these robots can understand what actions to take by themselves, without human-defined instructions. For instance, Aloha’s robot only needs to observe a person performing a task 50 times to learn to do it on its own, with a success rate exceeding 80%.

As a matter of fact, they are not merely copying human movements; they genuinely learn to perform these tasks. This is why we see Figure One’s robot correcting errors on its own. Humans did not teach it what to do when something goes wrong; it figured it out by itself and adjusted accordingly.

In theory, neural networks can learn anything in the world. With the increasing size of neural networks, growing computational power of computers, and the availability of more data, we are quickly approaching a future where robots can replace all manual labor. To be more precise, it is highly probable that within 20 years, robots will handle tasks such as ordering food, shaking drinks, cleaning, and cooking for us.

In conclusion, the rapid advancements in robotics, exemplified by Stanford’s Mobile Aloha and Figure’s Figure One, signify a future where robots seamlessly integrate into our daily lives, revolutionizing household tasks and playing a crucial role in transforming mundane chores into automated, efficient processes.

27. What is the main purpose of the passage?
- (A) Predicting the future applications of robots.
 - (B) Analyzing the autonomous learning ability of humanoid robots.
 - (C) Exploring the use of robots in household tasks.
 - (D) Comparing the features of Stanford’s Mobile Aloha and Figure’s Figure One.
28. According to the passage, why can Figure One’s robot correct errors on its own?
- (A) Because it frequently receives instructions from humans.
 - (B) Because it has autonomous learning and adaptive capabilities.
 - (C) Because humans have pre-programmed error correction instructions.
 - (D) Because it imitates human movements.

29. Which of the following statements is **INCORRECT**?

- (A) Aloha's robot can learn on its own after observing a person perform a task 50 times, with a success rate exceeding 80%.
- (B) Figure One's robot merely imitates human movements and does not genuinely learn to perform tasks.
- (C) The passage mentions that the robots have a neural network brain for autonomous learning, not pre-programmed human instructions.
- (D) The future applications of robots will include tasks such as ordering food, shaking drinks, cleaning, and cooking.

30. According to the passage, why does the author believe robots can replace all manual labor in the future?

- (A) Neural networks are continually expanding, computer processing power is increasing, and data is growing.
- (B) Robots are equipped with efficient computer processors, enabling them to perform complex tasks.
- (C) Humans are gradually losing control over technology, and robots are gradually taking over human roles.
- (D) Robots learn pre-programmed instructions from humans, enabling them to perform tasks.

第 31 至 34 題為題組

In ancient stories, the star group Taurus comes from an interesting tale that involves gods, humans, and heroes. It all begins with the Tauros Kretaíos, a splendid bull sent by the powerful Poseidon, god of the oceans.

Queen Pasiphae of Crete was fascinated by the bull's beauty. Overwhelmed by a strong desire, she asked the clever craftsman Daedalus to make a wooden cow. Pasiphae hid inside this clever creation and **fulfilled her forbidden longing**, giving birth to the Minotauros – a being with a human body and a bull's head.

As fate would have it, Heracles, the renowned hero, was assigned the difficult task of capturing the Bull as one of his Twelve Labors. Heracles displayed his strength and courage, successfully accomplishing this formidable feat; yet, in an unexpected turn of events, he chose not to harm the creature and released it into the wild.

The Bull, now free from captivity, embarked on a journey that led it to the ancient town of Marathon in Athens. There, it caused widespread destruction and chaos in the peaceful

countryside. However, the hero Theseus, known for his bravery and cunning, rose to the challenge and confronted the menacing beast. In a fierce battle, Theseus emerged victorious, defeating the Bull and bringing peace to the land.

In recognition of its extraordinary tale and the role it played in the heroic deeds of Heracles and Theseus, the gods placed the Bull among the stars, calling it Taurus. Joined by other mythical creatures such as the Hydra and the Nemean Lion, Taurus stands as a celestial tribute to these legendary adventures.

Today, the stars of Taurus still shine in the night sky, reminding us of the amazing events in the ancient world, where gods, heroes, and mythical creatures lived together in enchanting stories.

31. What is the passage mainly about?

- (A) The origin of the Taurus constellation.
- (B) The display of courage and heroism.
- (C) The complexities of desire and the associated issues it gives rise to.
- (D) Fate and adventures.

32. Which of the following statements is **INCORRECT**?

- (A) Queen Pasiphae concealed herself within a wooden cow.
- (B) The Bull found its way to the Athenian town of Sparta.
- (C) The star group Taurus was created as a tribute to the Bull.
- (D) Theseus confronted and defeated the Bull in Athens.

33. Based on the content, which of the following inferences is correct?

- (A) The Minotaur was born before Queen Pasiphae coupled with the Bull.
- (B) The Bull was initially a peaceful creature.
- (C) Theseus and Heracles collaborated to capture the Bull.
- (D) The Bull's violent outburst in Marathon led to its elevation to the constellation Taurus.

34. What does "**fulfill one's forbidden longing**" in the 2nd paragraph mean?

- (A) It implies an act of satisfying one's intense and taboo desire.
- (B) It suggests expressing forbidden desires openly and without reservations.
- (C) It signifies the hiding of off-limits passions through clever manipulation.
- (D) It refers to the act of creating banned desires within oneself.

第 35 至 38 題為題組

The Festival of Colors, also known as Holi, is one of the most vibrant and joyous festivals celebrated in India. It is a Hindu spring festival that signifies the arrival of spring, the victory of good over evil, and the celebration of love and unity. Here's a description of the Festival of Colors in India:

Date and Duration: The Festival of Colors usually takes place on the last full moon day of the lunar month of Phalguna, which typically falls in February or March. The festival lasts for two days, although celebrations may vary in different regions of India. [1]

Rituals and Traditions: Holi is characterized by exuberant and colorful celebrations. People gather in open spaces, streets, and public squares, armed with dry powdered colors and water-filled balloons or water guns. The atmosphere is filled with laughter, music, and dance. [2] People apply vibrant colors on each other's faces, playfully drench each other with colored water, and exchange greetings and sweets.

Bonfire Night: The festival begins with a bonfire known as Holika Dahan on the evening before Holi. This ritual involves the burning of a symbolic bonfire to commemorate the triumph of good over evil. People gather around the bonfire, sing religious songs, perform prayers, and offer prayers to the deities.

Cultural Significance: Holi holds great cultural significance in India. [3] It is believed that Prahlada's devotion to Lord Vishnu protected him from the destructive powers of Holika, and thus Holi celebrates the victory of good over evil.

35: Holi is a time when social barriers are temporarily set aside. People from all walks of life, regardless of caste, creed, or social status, come together to celebrate and enjoy the festival. It promotes a sense of unity, harmony, and brotherhood among communities. Holi is also a time for forgiveness and letting go of past grievances, as people embrace each other with colors and exchange warm wishes.

Regional Variations: While the essence of Holi remains the same throughout India, there are regional variations in the way it is celebrated. For example, in the state of Uttar Pradesh, the birthplace of Holi, the festivities are particularly exuberant, with cities like Mathura and Vrindavan hosting grand celebrations. [4] In the state of Punjab, Holi is celebrated with great enthusiasm as the festival coincides with the Sikh festival of Hola Mohalla.

35. What is the best subtitle for the descriptions in the sixth passage?

- (A) Joyous Participation across the World
- (B) Social Unity and Forgiveness
- (C) Culinary Delights
- (D) Religions Rituals and Worshipping

36. Which of the following words is closest in meaning to "grievances"?

- (A) unhappiness
- (B) patience
- (C) guidance
- (D) recovery

37. Where will the following sentence be best placed in the passage?

It is associated with various mythological legends, the most popular being the story of Prahlada and the demoness Holika

- (A) 1
- (B) 2
- (C) 3
- (D) 4

38. Based on the passage, which of the following is TRUE?

- (A) The Festival of Colors lasts for three to five days.
- (B) The festival begins with people applying vibrant colors on each other's faces
- (C) Celebrations of this festival are the same throughout India.
- (D) Regardless of their social status, people can take part in the festival.

【測驗結束】